

DayByDay

Feature Recommendations

Most-Requested Features in Task Apps,
Recommended New Features, and
Personalized Roadmap for Rise By Day

Prepared May 2026 | Based on market research and codebase audit

Executive Summary

DayByDay (Rise By Day) is a desktop-first productivity app built with Tauri and React. It already combines tasks, time blocks, calendar views, Pomodoro focus, Spotify integration, and deep home-screen customization - a positioning similar to TickTick's all-in-one model but with a stronger emphasis on visual identity and daily rhythm.

This document covers three areas: (1) the features users most frequently request across leading task apps, (2) recommended new features for the category in 2025-2030, and (3) a personalized roadmap for DayByDay based on what the app already ships versus what competitors offer and users consistently ask for.

1. Most Requested Features Across Task Apps

Synthesized from Todoist forums, TickTick reviews, Super Productivity GitHub issues, Reddit r/productivity threads, and 2025-2026 app comparisons. These appear repeatedly regardless of which app users currently use.

1.1 Top 10 by Request Frequency

- #1 Natural language task input: Type 'Call dentist tomorrow 2pm #health !!' and have dates, projects, and priority parsed automatically. Todoist's headline feature; #1 wish in most comparisons.
- #2 Bulk / multi-select operations: Select many tasks to reschedule, delete, move, or tag at once. Super Productivity issue #7058 and TickTick forums cite this constantly.
- #3 Two-way calendar sync: Google, Outlook, iCloud. Users want tasks AND events in one timeline with real-time sync, not 15-minute polling.
- #4 Time blocking on calendar: Drag tasks onto hour slots. Todoist added this under years of pressure; Sunsama/Akiflow exist because Todoist's version is barebones.
- #5 Smart recurring task handling: Edit one instance vs. all future; skip when traveling; handle exceptions without breaking the series.
- #6 Subtasks with progress roll-up: Nested checklists where parent shows X/Y complete. Table stakes for Todoist, TickTick, Things, Asana.
- #7 Saved filters / smart lists: Persistent queries like 'due this week + high priority + @work'. Power users live in custom views.
- #8 Built-in focus timer linked to tasks: TickTick's Pomodoro is its highest-rated feature. Users want session history tied to specific tasks.
- #9 Cross-device sync + offline mode: 640+ Reddit requests for offline-first tools. Sync on reconnect with conflict resolution.
- #10 Undo and task history: Recover accidentally deleted or rescheduled tasks. Surprisingly high demand given how rarely apps ship it.

1.2 Other High-Demand Categories

Calendar & scheduling

- Deadline vs. due date (Todoist shipped this in 2025 after years of requests)
- Conflict detection when scheduling over existing meetings
- Multiple views: day, 3-day, week, month, agenda, timeline

- Focus time auto-blocking based on task estimates

Focus & habits

- Habit tracking with streaks alongside tasks (TickTick bundle)
- Eisenhower Matrix for urgent/important sorting
- Distraction blocking during focus sessions
- Weekly/daily review workflows (GTD-inspired)
- Time tracking per task with reports

Capture & input

- Voice input / dictation on mobile
- Email-to-task forwarding
- Browser extension highlight-to-task
- Quick capture widgets (menu bar, home screen)
- Keyboard shortcuts and CLI for power users

Collaboration

- Shared projects with assignees and @mentions
- Comments and attachments on tasks
- Activity feed / audit trail
- Guest access without full accounts

Platform & trust

- Import from Todoist/TickTick/Things (CSV, JSON)
- API and webhooks for automation
- Local-first / privacy mode with optional self-hosting
- End-to-end encryption (growing EU demand)

2. Recommended New Features (Industry Trends 2025-2030)

2.1 AI-Powered Features (Fastest-Growing Segment)

The AI task manager sub-market is projected to grow from \$2.44B (2025) to \$5.76B by 2035 at ~18% CAGR. Users expect AI to reduce planning friction, not replace judgment.

- AI Daily Planner: morning briefing that reads calendar + tasks and proposes an optimized day
- Natural language capture: parse dates, times, projects, and priority from plain English
- AI task breakdown: decompose 'Launch website' into actionable subtasks with estimates
- Predictive rescheduling: auto-adjust when meetings run over or priorities shift
- Agentic AI with transparency: visible action logs and approval gates before AI acts
- Energy-based scheduling: tag tasks by cognitive load, schedule deep work at peak hours

2.2 All-in-One Life Dashboard

TickTick proved that bundling tasks + calendar + habits + Pomodoro in one app wins on value. Users are tired of juggling 4-6 apps (Todoist + Google Calendar + Forest + Notion + Spotify).

- Unified dashboard: tasks, calendar, habits, Pomodoro stats, and streaks in one view
- Weekly planning ritual: guided Sunday/Monday workflow to reduce planning paralysis
- Task aging alerts: surface tasks untouched 30+ days with reschedule/delegate/delete prompts
- Context-aware focus: tie Spotify/music, blocklists, and timer to the current task block

2.3 Differentiation Opportunities

- Calendar Block Builder: Drag tasks onto calendar to create time blocks that sync as calendar events. Gap analysis: 'You have 2 hours free Thursday afternoon'.
- Task Templates Marketplace: Community templates: 'Product launch', 'Move apartment', 'Weekly review'. One-click import with subtasks and durations.
- Accountability Pods: Small groups (2-5) share weekly goals and check in async. Lightweight peer accountability, not full PM.
- Local-First Privacy Mode: End-to-end encrypted sync, optional self-hosting, no AI training on user data. Targets privacy-conscious professionals.
- Smart Recurring Engine: Calendar-aware recurrence: 'Water plants' skips when traveling. 'Weekly report' auto-creates subtasks from last week's template.
- Lightweight Dependencies: Simple 'blocked by' links without full Gantt. Auto-unblock when dependency completes.
- Gamification (Opt-In): XP, streak badges, level-ups. Must be optional - ADHD community often loves it; others hate it.

3. DayByDay Current Feature Audit

Based on codebase review of Rise By Day (May 2026). This maps what you already ship against the most-requested feature list above.

3.1 Already Built (Competitive Strengths)

- Pomodoro timer with task linking: Global dock, focus panel, linked task title, session counting. Matches TickTick's top feature.
- Time blocks (daily rhythm): Configurable morning/afternoon/evening blocks with active-block banner on home screen. Unique differentiator vs. Todoist.
- Calendar drag-to-schedule: useCalendarTaskDrop hook: drag tasks onto day/week/month/agenda views to set dueDate/endDate.
- Multiple calendar views: Day agenda, week, and month grid views implemented.
- Task kinds: task, event, reminder, habit, class, ics - richer model than basic to-do apps.
- Recurrence engine: Daily/weekly/monthly with weekday selection and untilDate. advanceRecurrenceDate on completion.
- Categories, tags, blocks, priorities: Full categorization with color/icon config. Critical flag for urgent items.
- ICS calendar import: Import .ics files; dedup via icsUid; read-only imported events.
- Spotify integration: Dedicated screen and toolkit panel. Rare in task apps - strong focus/music angle.
- Deep home customization: Theme registry, clock styles, block/ribbon/tasks visual styles, separate style editor window.
- Class/student workflow: Class task kind with location, grade metadata, and dedicated toolkit window.
- Audio feedback: Customizable task click sounds (chew, happy, piano). Delight factor.
- Desktop-native (Tauri): Native window, home style popup window, local storage performance.
- Connected calendars UI: Google connect flow and calendar picker (currently mock/local state).
- Task command bar & sidebar: Quick navigation, today tasks panel, global create-task action.

3.2 Gaps vs. User Expectations

- Natural language input: Not implemented. TaskCreator uses structured form fields.
- Bulk / multi-select: No multi-select for batch reschedule, delete, or move.
- Subtasks: Task model has no parentId or nested children.
- Real calendar sync: Google integration is mock data; no OAuth or two-way sync yet.
- Smart filters / saved views: No persistent filter queries across categories/tags/blocks.
- Undo / history: No soft-delete or action rollback in tasksStore.
- Cloud sync / mobile: LocalStorage only via Zustand persist; no cross-device sync or mobile app.
- Habit tracking UI: habit kind exists in types but no streak UI or habit-specific views.
- Weekly review workflow: No guided review screen with stats and overdue triage.
- Task comments / activity log: notes field exists but no timestamped comment thread or audit trail.
- Time tracking: Pomodoro counts sessions but no per-task duration log or reports.
- Import from competitors: ICS import only; no Todoist/TickTick/Things migration path.
- Offline conflict resolution: Single-device local storage; no sync conflicts to resolve.

- AI features: No NLP parsing, prioritization, or daily planning assistant.
- Keyboard shortcuts docs: Some navigation hooks exist; no comprehensive shortcut palette.
- Focus mode shell: Pomodoro panel exists but no full-screen distraction-free deep work mode.

4. Personalized Recommendations for DayByDay

These recommendations leverage your existing architecture. Each item notes why it fits DayByDay specifically, not just the category in general.

4.1 Quick Wins (Build on What Exists)

P0**Link Pomodoro sessions to task IDs with history**

You already store `linkedTaskTitle` as a string. Persist `taskId`, log completed focus minutes per task, and show stats on the home screen. Turns your Pomodoro from a timer into TickTick's most-loved feature with minimal new UI.

P0**Habit streak view for habit-kind tasks**

`TaskKind` already includes 'habit' and `lastCompletedAt` exists. Add a streak counter, habit grid on home or toolkit, and daily reminder. No schema change needed.

P1**Bulk task operations**

Shift+click or checkbox multi-select in `TasksFrontPage` and calendar views. Batch reschedule, delete, change block/category. Consistently #2 most-requested feature.

P1**Saved smart filters**

You have categories, tags, blocks, priorities, and critical flag. Add named filter presets ('Today + Work block + High priority') stored in `settingsStore`. High impact for power users.

P1**Undo last task action**

Keep a rolling snapshot in `tasksStore` before mutations. One Cmd+Z to recover deleted/rescheduled tasks. Low complexity, disproportionate user trust gain.

4.2 Strategic Differentiators (Your Unique Angle)

- P0

'Plan My Block' unified daily view
 Combine active time block banner, today's tasks filtered to current block, calendar timeline, and Pomodoro start button in one screen. Your block system + calendar drag + Pomodoro is already 80% there - this is the product story competitors can't copy easily.
- P0

Spotify focus playlists tied to blocks
 When 'Deep Work' block starts, auto-play a linked Spotify playlist. When block ends, fade out. You have Spotify integration AND block configs - no competitor has this combination natively.
- P1

Full Focus Mode shell
 Extend GlobalPomodoroDock into a full-screen overlay: hide sidebar, show current task + timer + block context + optional website blocklist (Tauri can enforce). 'Focus OS Mode' from research.
- P1

Home Style theme marketplace
 Your theme registry (coreThemes, sectionStyles, custom themes) is unusually deep. Let users share/export theme JSON packs. Community themes become a growth loop and moat.
- P2

Class semester planner
 You already have class tasks, toolkit window, and grade/location metadata. Build a semester view: weekly class schedule, assignment due dates, exam countdown. Targets student persona that TickTick/ToDoist serve poorly.
- P2

Weekly review ritual screen
 Guided flow: show overdue tasks, Pomodoro hours this week, habit streaks, block utilization, and prompt to reschedule/archive. Uses data you already collect.

4.3 Foundation Work (Unlock Future Growth)

- P1

Real Google Calendar OAuth + two-way sync
 Replace mock connectGoogle with Tauri OAuth flow. Push scheduled tasks as calendar events; pull events as ics-kind tasks. Required for users who won't adopt a calendar-less task app.
- P1

Natural language task capture
 Parse 'Finish report tomorrow 3pm #work !!' in TaskCreatorPopupForm. Use a lightweight date parser (chrono/luxon patterns) before considering LLM. Headline marketing feature.
- P2

Subtasks with parent roll-up
 Add parentId to Task type. Show nested checklist in task popup. Enables project breakdown and AI task decomposition later.
- P2

Cloud sync layer
 Abstract Zustand persist behind a sync adapter. Start with optional Supabase/Firebase sync for tasks + settings. Prerequisite for mobile companion app.
- P3

AI daily planner
 Morning briefing: read today's blocks, calendar events, and open tasks; propose a schedule. Gate behind settings; use local LLM or API with explicit opt-in. Fits 'Plan My Block' vision.
- P3

Import from Todoist/TickTick
 CSV/JSON import mappers. Reduces switching cost for users evaluating DayByDay.

5. Suggested 6-Month Roadmap

Phase 1: Polish the Core (Weeks 1-6)

- Pomodoro-to-task session history and per-task focus stats
- Habit streak UI for existing habit-kind tasks
- Undo for task delete/reschedule
- Bulk select + batch operations in task list
- Saved smart filters (categories + tags + blocks + priority)

Phase 2: The DayByDay Story (Weeks 7-12)

- 'Plan My Block' unified daily planning view
- Spotify playlist auto-start per time block
- Full-screen Focus Mode shell with distraction blocking
- Weekly review ritual screen with stats
- Real Google Calendar OAuth (read-first, then write-back)

Phase 3: Growth Features (Weeks 13-24)

- Natural language task input
- Subtasks with parent progress roll-up
- Theme export/import and community theme sharing
- Class semester planner view
- Cloud sync foundation + import from Todoist/TickTick
- AI daily planner (opt-in beta)

6. Competitive Positioning Summary

DayByDay sits at the intersection of TickTick (all-in-one productivity), Things 3 (premium personal UX), and Tiimo (visual daily rhythm). Your strongest positioning:

- NOT another plain to-do list - a daily rhythm app with time blocks, focus, and music
- Desktop-native performance and customization depth that web apps can't match
- Student/class workflow as a underserved niche within the productivity category
- Visual identity as a feature - themes, sounds, and home layout as personalization moat

Avoid competing head-on with:

- Asana/ClickUp on team project management (different buyer, different complexity)
- Todoist on integration count (80+ integrations took 15+ years)
- Notion on docs/wiki (stay focused on daily execution)

7. Target Personas for DayByDay

The Block Planner

Structures their day in morning/afternoon/evening chunks. Wants: active block awareness, tasks filtered to current block, calendar time-blocking, Pomodoro. DayByDay's core persona.

The Focus-First Student

Uses: TickTick or Notion. Wants: class schedule, assignment tracking, Pomodoro, minimal clutter. DayByDay's class kind + toolkit + blocks serve this directly.

The Aesthetic Productivity User

Uses: Things 3 or custom Notion dashboards. Wants: beautiful home screen, themes, sounds, personalization. DayByDay's HomeStyleEditor and theme registry are built for this.

The Music-Focused Worker

Pairs Spotify with Pomodoro/Forest. Wants: focus playlists tied to work sessions. DayByDay's Spotify integration is a unique hook no major task app offers natively.

The Desktop Power User

Uses: Super Productivity or self-hosted tools. Wants: keyboard shortcuts, local data, native performance, no subscription. Tauri desktop app + local-first storage fits.

8. Sources & Methodology

- DayByDay codebase audit (src/stores, src/screens, src/components, src/types) - May 2026
- The Business Research Company - Task Management Software Market Report 2026
- Precedence Research - AI Task Manager App Market Size 2025-2035
- Super Productivity GitHub Issues (community feature requests)
- Todoist vs TickTick vs Things 3 comparisons (Rivva, ToolChief, ClickUp, Efficient App, 2025-2026)
- BigIdeasDB - What Apps Do People Wish Existed 2026 (Reddit dataset analysis)
- Asana - AI Agents Built for Teams: Shared Context and Transparency (2026)

Disclaimer: Feature priorities should be validated with your user base through surveys, beta feedback, and usage analytics. Market figures represent commonly reported ranges and vary by research firm scope.